



Factory Method

All things you should know about Factory.



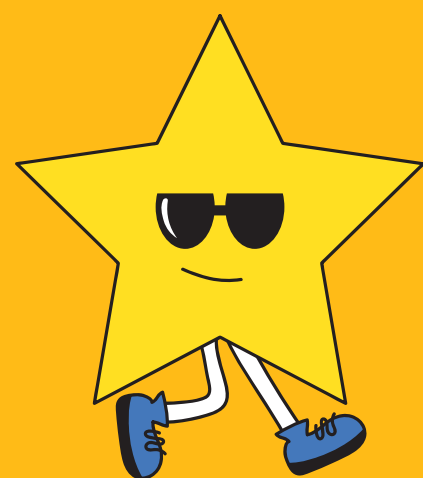
What is Factory Method?

It belongs to the creational category.

It lets a class defer instantiation to subclasses and it is known as Virtual Constructor.



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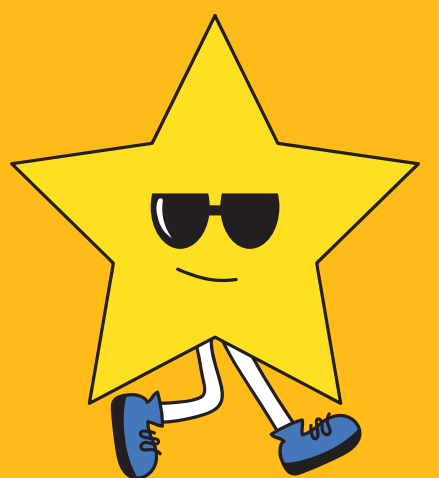
Problem



Imagine, we have an abstract class named document and it has different implementations and also there is an abstract class named application which is responsible for managing documents and creating them. Since the particular document subclass to instantiate is application-specific the application class just **knows when to create** document, but it **cannot guess what kind of document** it should create.



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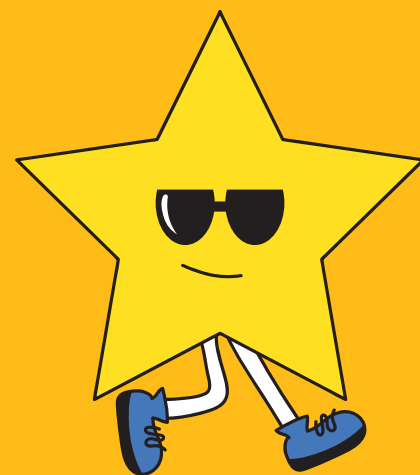


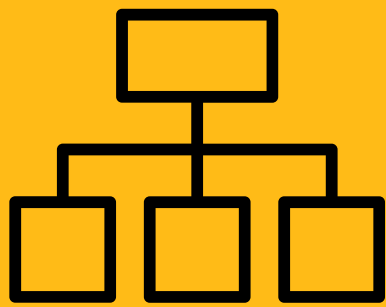
Solution

Factory Method

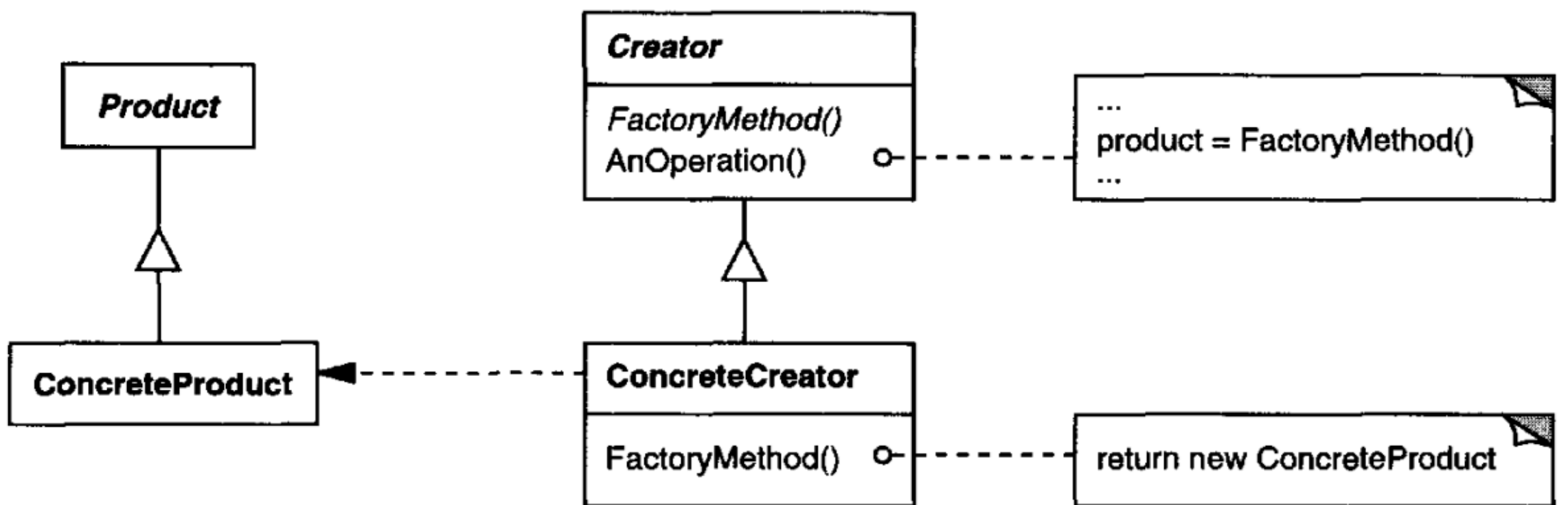


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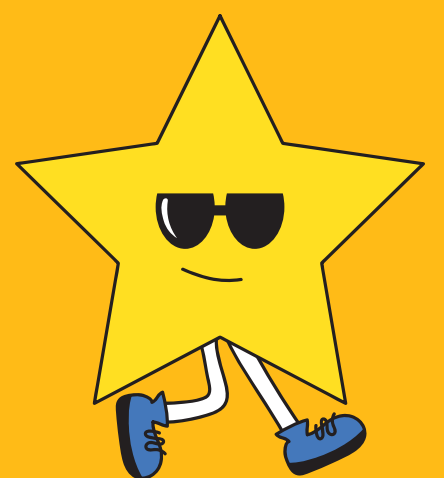




Structure



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Usability



A class cannot anticipate the class of objects it must create.

A class wants its subclasses to specify the objects it creates.

Classes delegate responsibility to one of several helper subclasses, and you want to localize the knowledge of which helper subclass is the delegate.



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